



SIGNED THE DOCUMENTS AND JUMPED INTO THE SEAT OF SUPREME POWER

Conceding that Jinnah, the clever lawyer and astute politician, was no conservative Muslim teetotaler, or even a regular patron of the mosque, or a performer of namaaz, it has to be emphasised that he played the communal card after his return from self-imposed exile in England, that a secular person using the communal slogan is much more dangerous than a straight forward communalist. He claimed the monopoly for voicing the demands of Muslims. He objected to Nehru claiming to speak for all Indians, Hindus and Muslims alike, and specifically asked (ordered?) Nehru to speak only for "his people", i.e. the Hindus, as far back as 1937.

Jinnah has to take the chief responsibility for Partition as far as it is the responsibility of a leader, though he is not the first accused. That position

clearly belongs to the British Government, and Jinnah comes only as the second accused. Historians will agree that no single cause can be attributed to great events, and that there are remote and immediate causes in such matters, apart from individual party leaders and their followers. However, Nehru cannot be absolved of the responsibility for Partition, as he was the one who carried the mighty Congress with him, signed the documents and jumped into the seat of supreme power. He has to be cited as the third accused, after Churchill and Jinnah, though he can be exonerated on account of services to the nation and the world at large.

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